Counting Flag Football: a data product, end to end

SYNTHETIC DATA

Three business goals, turned into five data products that are owned, measured and safe for kids.

I acted as data product manager. Built for a privacy lead and a club-marketing lead.

1 · WHAT WOULD YOU BUILD FOR THESE GOALS?

Each goal has one product that moves it directly.

Three goals led to five products.

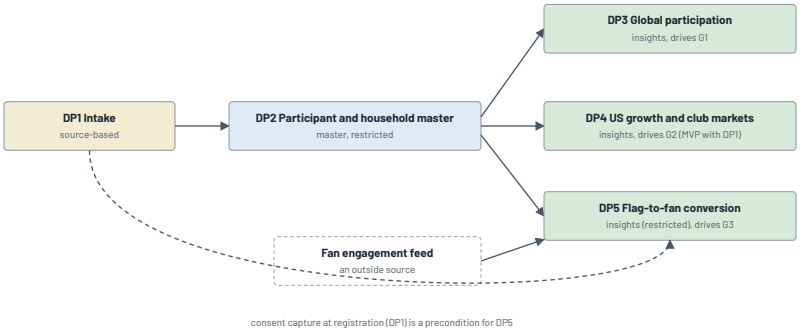
Goal	DP1 Intake	DP2 Master	DP3 Global	DP4 US growth	DP5 Fan conversion
G1 Grow the NFL globally	Utility	Enabler	Driver		
G2 Grow flag in the US as a safe, low-cost way into football	Utility	Enabler		Driver	
G3 Turn families into fans		Enabler			Driver

Driver: moves the goal directly. Enabler: makes other products possible. Utility: keeps things running.

2 · WHAT WOULD YOU BUILD FOR THESE GOALS? (CONTINUED)

Intake feeds the master, and the master feeds the three insight products.

Conversion also needs the fan feed and guardian consent.



3 · WHO ARE THE PRODUCTS FOR?

Six personas, and what we'd ask them.

There are no real users yet, so these are assumptions to test.

International growth lead

Serves G1

Decide which countries to invest in

We would ask: Which decisions did you make last year without data?

NFL FLAG domestic operations lead

Serves G2

Know where flag is growing and where leagues are struggling

We would ask: Which numbers do you distrust today, and why?

Club youth and community manager

Serves G2, G3

Grow flag in our market and connect families to the club

We would ask: What would you do differently with a market view?

Fan and club marketing analyst

Serves G3

Show that flag creates fans, and reach families who agreed to be reached

We would ask: What evidence would convince finance that flag drives fandom?

Privacy and compliance lead

Serves G3 (guardrail)

Make sure children's data is never misused

We would ask: What would make you comfortable approving club access?

League operator (volunteer)

Serves G2 (supplier)

Run the league and send the data that is asked for

We would ask: What is the most you would fill in at registration?

4 · WHAT IS EACH PRODUCT?

Each product has a label: owner, version, live quality grade and rules for use.

Open one to see who uses it and what it must never do.

Product	Type	Status	Version	Quality	Owner	Rule
DP1 Intake	Source-based	MVP · building	v2.0.0	Grade C	Data Product Manager, NFL FLAG Insights (fictional)	Never: re-identification of a child from an intake file
DP2 Master	Master	Proposed	v0.10.0	Identity error under 1%	Data Product Manager, NFL FLAG Insights (fictional)	Never: marketing access to the master
DP3 Global	Insights	Proposed	v0.9.0	Grade C	Data Product Manager, NFL FLAG Insights (fictional)	Never: publishing a country count below the small-cell size
DP4 US growth	Insights	MVP · building	v1.1.0	Grades vary by market	Data Product Manager, NFL FLAG Insights (fictional)	Never: individual targeting
DP5 Fan conversion	Insights	Proposed	v0.1.0	Grade D	Data Product Manager, NFL FLAG Insights (fictional)	Never: child-level targeting

So what. Every product has an owner and rules. Nobody uses kids' data by accident.

5 · WHAT DO WE BUILD FIRST, AND WHY?

Intake and US growth first. Conversion waits: high value, data not ready.

Each product is scored on value, feasibility, readiness and privacy risk.

Product	Value	Feasibility	Readiness	Privacy risk	Total	Reading
DP1 Intake	4	5	3	1	**11**	Build first
DP4 US growth	5	4	3	2	**10**	Build first
DP2 Master	4	4	4	4	**8**	Next
DP3 Global	4	3	2	2	**7**	High value, low readiness: sequenced, not deprioritized
DP5 Fan conversion	5	2	1	5	**3**	High value, low readiness: sequenced, not deprioritized

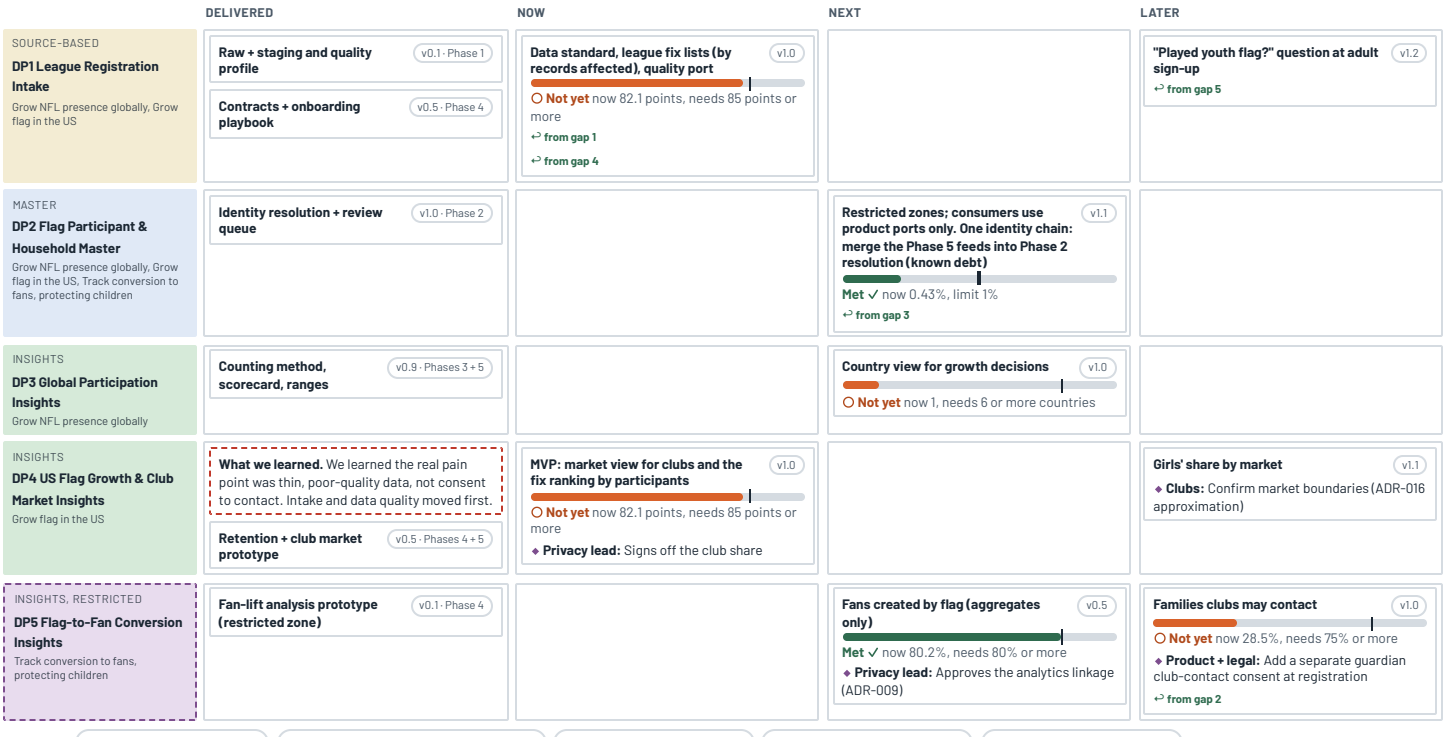
Scores 1 to 5. Total = value + feasibility + readiness - privacy risk.

So what. We build where value is high and the data is ready, and we say why the rest waits.

6 · WHAT HAS TO BE TRUE BEFORE EACH PRODUCT MOVES?

2 of 6 release gates met. The MVP waits on the US data score (82 → 85).

No dates: a product moves when its gate is met and the right person signs off.



No dates: products move when their data is good enough and the right person has signed off. Bars show where a gate stands; the tick is the target. ◆ marks a decision. Targets are set for a synthetic dataset.

So what. The roadmap is a set of tests a product must pass, not a calendar.

7 · HOW DO WE PROTECT KIDS?

Minors are guardian-only. We count families, never kids.

9% of families with a child under 13 agreed to club contact.

Under 13	13–15	16–17	18+
Guardian	Guardian	Guardian	Self, fresh consent
Counted in totals · club contact only via guardian consent	Counted in totals · club contact only via guardian consent	Counted in totals · club contact only via guardian consent	Own fan record, only with fresh consent
9% agreed to club contact: 520 of 5,790 families	**9%** agreed to club contact: 190 of 2,230 families	**8%** agreed to club contact: 190 of 2,250 families	**5%** agreed to club contact: 60 of 1,350 families

~~Marketing to under-18s~~ · ~~Buying data about kids~~ · ~~Fuzzy family matching~~ · ~~Scoring families~~ · ~~Youth records past 18~~

So what. Contacting families is limited by consent, not by data. The only way to grow it is to ask clearly at registration, never to buy or guess.

8 · IS IT WORKING?

Fans created by flag: about 1,300 (900–1,600).

One row per goal, then the health of each product.

G1
7,400
from prototype (v0.9)

7,400 players in 8 countries. Only 1 reports at grade B or better.

Not yet: now 1, needs 6 or more countries

So what. We can count globally, but can't compare countries fairly yet.

G2
47%

Girls 47% · 58% play again · 14 of 76 leagues sent no file.

Not yet: now 82.1 points, needs 85 points or more

So what. Growth looks real, but missing leagues mean we undercount it.

G3
1,300
from prototype (v0.1)

About 1,300 new fans (900–1,600) · engaged families +20% · 36% of families linked.

Not yet: now 28.5%, needs 75% or more

So what. Flag does create fans. With only 36% of families linked, this is a floor, not the full number.

2025, synthetic

Product	Quality	Tests	Boundary breaks	Privacy checks	Status
DP1 Intake	Grade C	✓	0	✓	**Watch** Quality: C
DP2 Master	Identity error under 1%	✓	0	✓	**Watch** Age-rule rows still unverified: 23
DP3 Global	Grade C	✓	0	✓	**Watch** Quality: C
DP4 US growth	Grades vary by market	✓	0	✓	**Watch** Quality: A: 12, B: 4, C: 5, D: 5
DP5 Fan conversion	Grade D	✓	0	✓	**Watch** Quality: D

So what. The data is healthy enough to trust the direction, not yet the decimals.

9 · WHERE ARE THE GAPS, AND WHAT DID THEY CHANGE?

7 gaps found. 5 of them changed the roadmap.

Each gap shows its evidence and the card it moved.

Gap	Evidence	Product	What it changed	Roadmap
US data score is below target	now 82.1 points, needs 85 points or more	DP4	Blocks the DP1 and DP4 release; intake and quality went first (the pivot)	Changed roadmap
Consent fully known for too few families	now 28.5%, needs 75% or more	DP5	Club contact moved to Later; guardian consent added at sign-up as a decision	Changed roadmap
A second identity chain was found	planned for v1.1	DP2	Added the "one identity chain" card	Changed roadmap
Leagues that sent no file	14 of 76 leagues	DP1	The send-your-file fix ranks first on every fix list	Changed roadmap
Youth-to-adult link cannot be measured	Fresh consent at 18 and no carry-over: a youth record is not linked to the adult by design	DP5	Added the played-youth-flag question at adult sign-up	Changed roadmap
Age rules not yet verified	23 of 28 rules	DP1	No roadmap change; the strictest rule applies	Watch
Too few countries at grade B	now 1, needs 6 or more countries	DP3	No roadmap change; it is the gate for the country view	Watch

So what. The roadmap moved because of what the data showed, not on a schedule.

10 · WHAT DID WE LEARN, AND WHAT'S NEXT?

We started with consent. The real problem was thin, messy data.

	What	So what
Pivot	Started with consent to contact; the real problem was thin, messy data.	We fixed supply first. A better model on bad data is still wrong.
Known debt	A second identity chain; merge planned (DP2 v1.1).	We track shortcuts openly and pay them down: boundary breaks went from 23 to 0.
Next decision	The privacy lead approves the fan analysis; product and legal add guardian consent at sign-up.	It unlocks DP5: the first time clubs can reach families, with consent.

All figures synthetic, built to test the method Full detail: Data product tab → Methodology 2.0